

2. One letter stream, two lexical readings

OUTPUT *Abstract.* Exact palindromes couple a formal character constraint with lexical segmentation: after letters are reversed, original word boundaries need not survive. We therefore study whether an English letter stream can be read plausibly in both directions. Our decoder is a case study of this dual-reading requirement; its two-ended state exposes the unresolved letters that one side owes the other. The intended contribution is a linguistic account of why exact palindrome generation is difficult.

CRITIQUE The key intuition is now linguistic, but the proposed comparison would still be unfair if it compared an author's original spaces with automatically recovered spaces in the reversal. That would mix reversal with a boundary-treatment artifact.

REVISION APPLIED Apply exactly the same vocabulary and segmentation procedure to both the forward letters and their reversal before comparing the readings.